Know How

Q&A Section

Q I have a server running CentOS 5 with Joomla, WordPress, Plone and other Web applications. The server crashes very frequently and stops responding. One of my friends suggested that this could be due to a memory leak. Please provide me more information about memory leaks and how I ought to manage the problem.

—Naveen Chawla, New Delhi

A memory leak is a condition wherein your server faces a gradual loss of available memory. This is due to a bug(s) in a program that allocates the memory to the program and does not de-allocate it when the need is over. As a result, it ends up eating all the system memory available on the server.

Memory leaks may be one of the problems your server is facing. But I won't be able to help you much as I need to study your log files to check what's making your server stop responding. The reasons could be many, and not only necessarily a memory leak. So, I'd recommend analysing the relevant log files.

Q I am a regular reader of your *Q and A* section. I have been using Mandriva 2008 on my desktop for the past several months and would like to thank you all for bringing out *LINUX For You* magazine, which helped me get rid of a non-free platform. Recently, I started facing a strange problem. Often, when I start K3b, it does not show up for a long time. Then I reboot my system and it starts properly. Can you please suggest how I can resolve this issue?

—Ivan, Imphal

A. There could be several reasons for K3b not starting. You do not need to restart, just *grep* the PID of K3b and kill it before trying to start K3b from a terminal. This will help you in identifying the exact problem it is encountering in starting up smoothly.

Q I have openSUSE 11.1 in my PC (Compaq Presario) – an AMD Athlon 64 machine with 512 MB of RAM. Now I want to connect to the Internet using my Tata Indicom USB modem. But I don't know how to do that in openSUSE. Kindly suggest a solution.

— Babanna Duggani, babanna.duggani@gmail.com

Most of the Tata Indicom USB modems work fine with Linux. As you have not mentioned the exact model number of the modem, I assume it's one of those that are supported. To make this modem work, follow the steps given below:

1. Open the terminal, become the root user and then check *dmesg* after connecting your USB device. *grep* and check the device name that the modem is assigned.
2. On the terminal window, run the following command:

```
[root@localhost ~] # wvdialconf /etc/
wvdial.conf
```

This will scan all connected serial devices, and if it detects the modem, it will write the configuration to */etc/wvdial.conf* (I assume that you have *wvdial* installed, if not then please install it before running this command).

3. Now open the */etc/wvdial.conf* file in any text editor, enter phone as *#777* and enter "internet" for username and password. If the lines are commented then uncomment them. Also, add the following at the end of the file:

```
Init3 = AT+CRM=1
Stupid Mode = 1
```

4. Now run the command wvdial and wait till you see something like:

```
local IP address xx.xxx.xxx.x
remote IP address xxx.xxx.x.xx
primary DNS address xxx.xxx.xx.xxx
secondary DNS address xxx.xxx.xxx.xxx
```

If you can see some values instead of these multiple Xs, then it means that you are connected.

5. Open your Web browser and start browsing. If unable to browse, then open the terminal and run the following command:

```
cp /etc/ppp/resolv.conf /etc/
```

This will ask you to replace the resolve.conf. Press 'y'. END